Conference or Training Request Approval Template
Attendance

Date 2026-10-24

Basic Information:

Agency: Rural Development (RD)

Program Area: Program area pending - R-16

Accounting Data: Pending - R-05 / R-21

Project code: Pending - R-21

Event Name: USDA RD Centralized Training (working title)

Event Date(s): 2026-11-29 thru 2026-12-01 Event Location: Boston; venue pending R-01

Primary POC: _____ Name / phone / email pending - R-21
Name, Phone, email

Secondary POC: _____ Name / phone / email pending - R-21
Name, Phone, email

Estimated Expense Total: $37,191.17 + 1.05 U

Select One: Conference ☐ Training ☑

If the event is training, is it considered Continuing Professional Education? Yes ☐ No ☐

Recurring Event: Yes ☐ No ☐ If yes, select ☐ Annual or ☐ Biennial ☐

Provide actual expense information for previous year(s) participation in this event.

Annual TBD R-14 Biennial TBD R-14

Narrative fields are limited to 8-10 lines of data using Times New Roman 10-pitch. Information beyond the visible field will not be viewed or printed

Event Purpose: (Narrative description of the Conference or Training objectives and expected outcomes.)

Proposed training November 29-December 1, 2026. Pending verification. State the training purpose with verifiable expected outcomes. Supply: course title, agenda/content outline, instructional objectives, and measurable post-training outcomes tied to duties. Identify which specific operational decision or capability gap the evidence supports. No topic, content, or outcome evidence has been provided; the DRAFT cannot assert outcomes until documented. Evidence request: R-16.

Was event included on the current year conference plan? Yes ☐ No ☐

If no, why was the event omitted ?

Plan inclusion is UNVERIFIED (R-12). Obtain the current-year conference-plan entry; if absent, the Program Office must explain omission before approval. Unchecked Yes/No boxes mean unresolved, not No.

How will the event help further the Agency's mission or the Department's strategic plan? (Narrative justification)

Pending verification. RD mission linkage required per RD Instruction 2036-A, 2036.74(b). A generic slogan is not proof. Supply the exact RD program or operating need this training serves and documentary substantiation (program requirement, regulatory driver, or performance gap). No substantiated linkage has been supplied; the DRAFT cannot certify mission linkage until specific program/operating evidence is provided. Evidence request: R-17.

The number of employees attending is appropriate to the purpose of the event and the mission of the agency. (Narrative justification)

Pending verification. Justify headcount by required role coverage, not affordability. For 18: supply roster, roles, and why each attendee's duties require this training. For 24: additionally justify the marginal six attendees with specific role coverage each adds. No roster, roles, or role-specific needs have been supplied. Neither the 18- nor 24-person count can be certified as necessary until documented. Evidence request: R-04.

The event is a "must-do" considering the limited budget of the agency. The information cannot be effectively shared through another means such as a teleconference, video conferencing, webinars, or other alternative media tools. (Narrative justification)

Pending verification. Per 2036.74(b), alternatives including teleconference must be assessed. Supply concrete evidence bearing on remote/hybrid suitability: delivery format, interaction requirements, any documented hands-on or facility dependencies, and feasibility findings. Do not invent hands-on needs; do not assert remote is impossible absent evidence. No business-necessity or feasibility evidence has been supplied, so remote/hybrid cannot be ruled out or in. Evidence request: R-18.

Federal funds will only be used for necessary and appropriate purposes and all conference expenses and activities will comply with the Federal Travel Regulation (FTR), the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR), the Agricultural Travel Regulation, and any other USDA requirements on lodging, food and beverages, per diem reimbursement, and contracting of goods and services.

Yes ☐ No ☐

Attendee Information:

Total Attendees: —— 24

Sponsoring Agency Attendees/Participants: 24

Other USDA Attendees/Participants: TBD

Other Federal Attendees/Participants: TBD

Non-Federal Attendees/Participants: TBD

Will contributions be accepted from non-federal sources to defray the cost of attending the conference?

☐ Yes ☐ No

If Yes, then how much will be accepted? TBD

If contributions will be accepted, has the acceptance decision been discussed with the Office of General Counsel? If yes, then ***please provide a copy of the OGC opinion.***

☐ Yes ☐ No

Will your agency be hosting a booth (USDA or otherwise) at the event?

☐ Yes ☐ No

Attachments:

1. ☐ Draft or previous year event agenda *(with specific information on how meals will be handled)*
2. ☐ Location Cost Estimate *(properly completed)*
3. ☐ Attendee Cost Detail spreadsheet *(excel soft copy version)*

Reportable (check all that apply):

☐ USDA OCFO [*over $7,000*]

☐ USDA OIG [*over $20,000]*

☐ HR933, Section 3003 [*over $100,000*]

APPLICATION DRAFT - NOT APPROVED / NO BOOKINGS
Unchecked boxes are UNVERIFIED, not "No" or not-applicable.
CPE/recurrence/history: R-14; plan: R-12; contributions/OGC/booth: R-13; compliance: R-21.
Cost priority: Boston, 24; no fully qualified recommendation yet. Dates: Nov 28-Dec 2.
Known/estimated base $35,420.16; 5% reserve $1,771.01; partial total $37,191.17.
Complete total = 1.05 x (base + U_city). U_city is additional unquoted BASE costs;
it is independent across cities/headcounts: venue, unpriced breakfast and venue travel.
Agenda: pending R-08/R-16. Location estimate: workbook Options/Daily; venue quote pending R-01.
Attendee detail: per-person cost basis exists; named actual expenses/roster pending R-11.
RD 2036-A (07/19/2024) section 2036.74(b): agency cost >$20,000 requires OCFO
advance approval. Old OCFO $7k / OIG $20k / HR933 labels: applicability pending R-07.
No funds, eligibility, compliance certification or signature is represented as confirmed.